

MODY AI

Human Computer Interaction 25/26

WHO WE ARE?



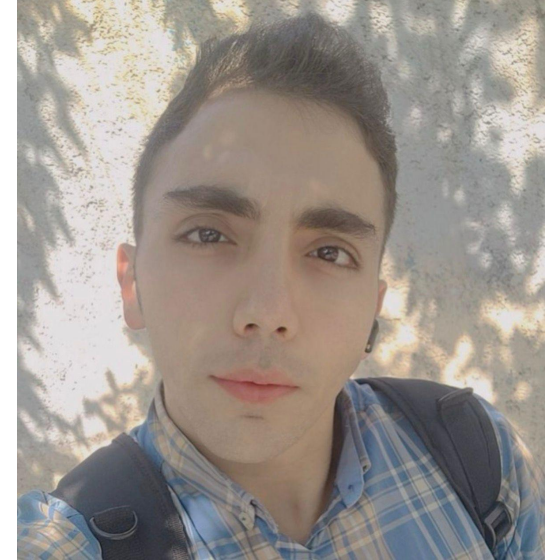
Zuhale Didem Aytac



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Domain: Learning to Draw as a Beginner

Many people are interested in drawing but find it difficult to improve on their own. Without clear guidance or feedback, it can be hard to know what to practice or how to start. We chose this domain because learning to draw involves a visible output that requires reflection and correction, which makes the process different from other types of self-learning. We wanted to understand how beginners approach drawing, what challenges they face, and how they find motivation or inspiration to continue.

Why did we chose this domain?

Many people are interested in drawing but find it hard to learn on their own.

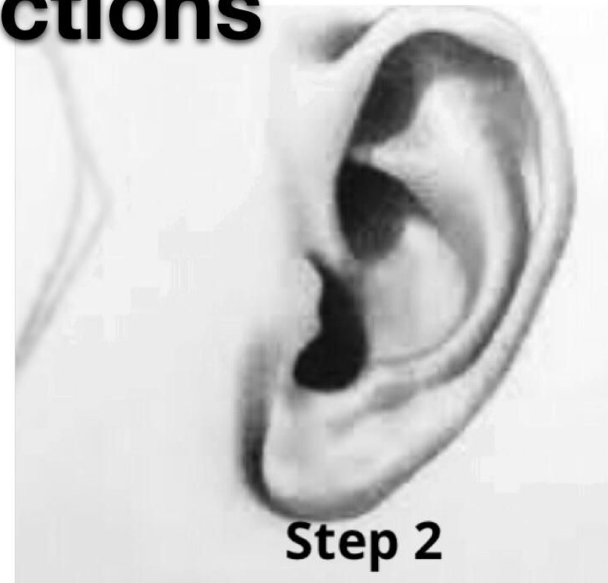
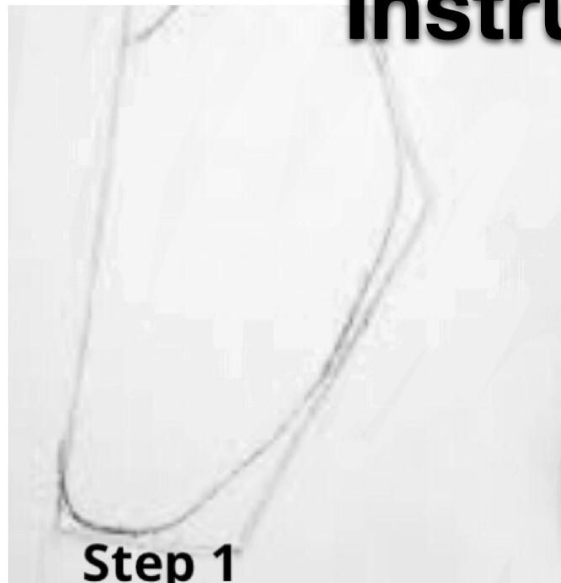
It's easy to start but difficult to keep improving without feedback or guidance.

Unlike other skills, drawing produces a visible result that can create frustration or self-doubt.

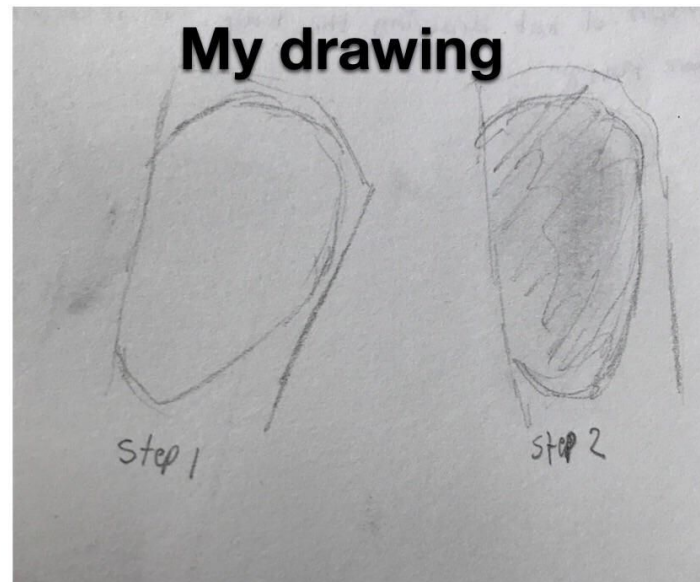
We wanted to understand what motivates beginners to keep practicing.

We were curious about how people find resources, inspiration, and ways to learn without formal help.

Instructions



made with mematic



PARTICIPANTS

P1 - Selen Yukeb – amateur painter who paints as a hobby (immediate user)

P2 - Ewa Walkovska – art instructor and owner of a new art studio in Nizza, Torino (domain expert)

P3 - Giuseppe Martano – He improved his skills after series of art classes during middle and high school (lead user)

P4 - Selin Ozciftci - Exhibiting artist and art instructor in Turkey (domain expert)

Procedure:

Two team members were present at each interview: one leading the conversation, one taking notes.

Interview 1: Didem conducted the interview, and Yusa took notes.

Interview 2: Didem conducted the interview, and Yusa connected remotely on mobile to take notes. This included a short **observation during an art workshop**.

Interview 3: Özgün conducted the interview, and Mohammad Reza took notes.

Interview 4: Yusa conducted the interview while the rest of the team joined remotely.

All participants gave **written consent** for recording and data use.

Methodology – Rationale & Interview Process

Why they were chosen:

They represent a diverse set of perspectives: from beginners struggling to start, to an experienced teacher who mentors others, and a passionate self-taught artist. This diversity helped us capture emotional and practical needs of learners at different stages.

Recruitment:

Participants were reached through personal connections and local art communities. One interview included an on-site observation during an art workshop at Ewa's studio.

P1

P1 - METHODOLOGY

Why chosen / appropriateness:

She represents a typical adult beginner who draws casually without formal training. Her experience reflects self-taught learners who use online sources for inspiration.

Recruitment:

Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile:

26 years old, female, doctor by profession, draws as a hobby in her free time.

Interview location:

Conducted face to face, in Torino

P1 - METHODOLOGY

Observation and questions:

We observed how she uses Pinterest for visual references. Questions focused on how she learns, what she finds difficult, and what keeps her motivated to continue.

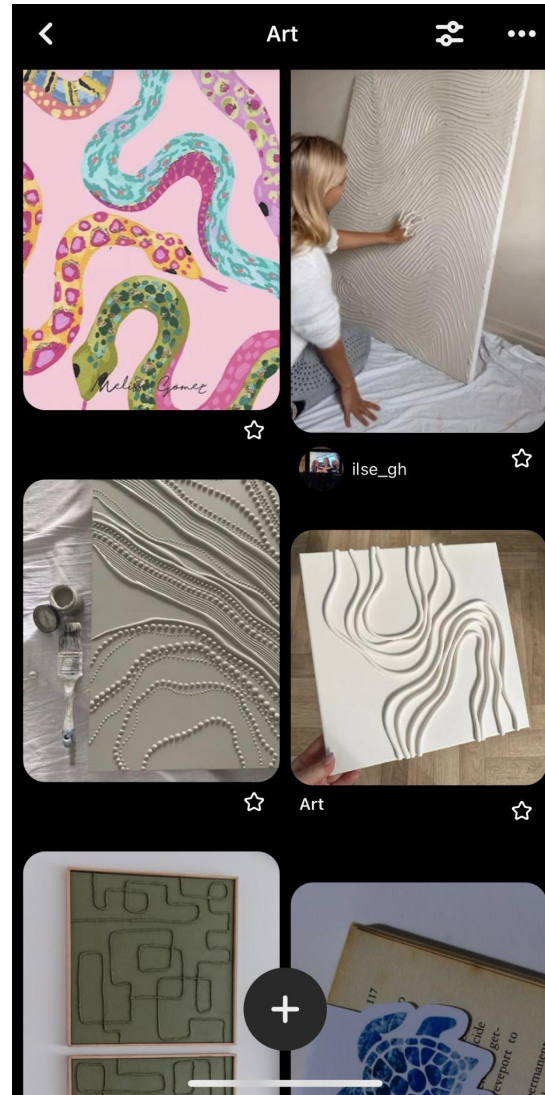
Team roles:

Didem led the interview and asked questions, Yusa took notes and handled the audio recording.

Materials used:

Audio recorder on phone, notebook for notes.

P1 - Artifacts



P1 - Key Quotes

“When I sit down to draw, I reconnect with myself and disconnect from everything else.”

“Sometimes I feel stuck because I don’t know what to practice next.”

“I usually search for inspiration on Pinterest when nothing around me inspires me.”

“I would love to get help when I can’t draw something I imagine, but I don’t know who to ask.”

P1 - User Needs

Needs a way to find inspiration easily when she feels stuck.

Needs to be able to get feedback and guidance without joining a formal class.

Needs a way to organize her drawing routine and stay consistent over time.

Needs to be able to experiment with materials safely without wasting them.

P2 - Methodology

Why chosen / appropriateness:

She is an experienced art instructor who recently opened her own workshop, making her an ideal domain expert to understand how drawing is taught and what challenges beginners face from a teacher's perspective.

Recruitment:

Found through a Facebook post announcing the opening of her new art studio in Nizza. She agreed to participate after being contacted physically.

Profile:

Female, late-20s, professional artist and instructor, teaches beginner and intermediate drawing courses.

Interview location:

Conducted in person at her art studio in Nizza.

Observation and questions:

We observed the studio setup, drawing materials, and ongoing student works displayed in the space. Questions focused on her teaching methods, student motivation, feedback practices, and reasons for opening the workshop.

Team roles:

Didem led the interview and managed the in-person discussion; Yusa joined online to take notes and monitor the recording.

Materials used:

Audio recording via phone, digital notes taken by Yusa, and photos of the studio environment and displayed artwork (with consent).

P2

P2 - Artifacts



<  Expats in Turin · [Katil](#)
Ewa Walkowska · 8 Eyl · 

NEW! Art Classes in English in Turin – for Kids & Adults

STARTING OCTOBER | SMALL GROUPS | NO EXPERIENCE NEEDED

Hi everyone!

I'm Ewa, a local artist and educator, and I'm opening a new creative space this October in Turin. It's called **Artive Workshop**, and it's for both kids and adults who wants to make art in an enriching, international space.

 **Small groups**

 **Turin (final venue coming soon)**

 **Taught in English**

Never painted before? Perfect.

Used to love art but stopped? Even better.

This space is for you.

Interested? Want details when sign-ups open?

Just comment **"YES"** or emoji and I'll DM you the info - no obligations, just updates.

 Beğen

 Yorum yap

 Paylaş

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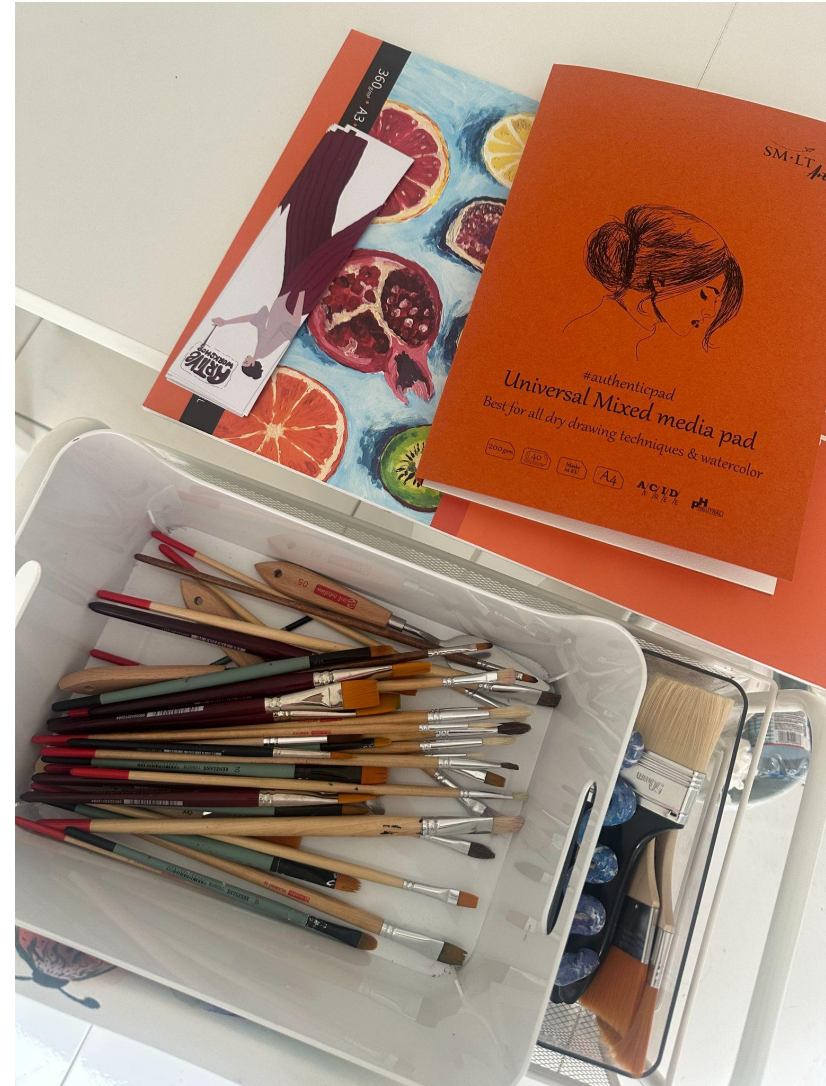
En alakalı ▾



Didem Aytaç adıyla yoru...







P2 - Key Quotes

“Many people start classes to get a creative outlet, a space that’s different from their everyday analytical work.”

“The biggest challenge for beginners is being too careful because they compare themselves to what they see online.”

“When students stop worrying about the final result, that’s when they really start improving.”

“For me, art is everything, my work, my hobby, my way to connect with people.”

P2 - User Needs

Needs a way to help students overcome fear of failure and perfectionism.

Needs tools to give quick, personalized feedback in group sessions.

Needs a way to keep students motivated between classes.

Needs to be able to bridge traditional art with modern digital tools effectively.

P3

P3 - METHODOLOGY

Why chosen / appropriateness:

He's an old-school artist who had art and art related projects all throughout his life. Even though he paints and does projects regularly, he doesn't feel confident. On top of that, his distance to the technology, gave us more unbiased image.

Recruitment:

Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile:

65 years old, male, veterinarian, draws and makes DIY projects in his free time..

Interview location:

Conducted face to face, in Chieri.

P3 - METHODOLOGY

Observation and questions:

Even tho he's been painting for 50 years, he never lost his interest in art. He solely follows his instincts and feelings, and didn't find the environment to work on new techniques. Not considering the digital tools didn't help him either.

Team roles:

Özgün led the interview and asked questions, Yusa took notes and handled the audio recording.

Materials used:

Audio recorder on phone, notebook for notes.

P3 - Key Quotes

“The thing that i struggle most is not being able to represent my imagination on the canvas”

“I prefer calm environments; I can't paint in noisy places.”

“Oil painting is hard, one part of the painting can take days to dry.”

“I like to paint landscapes, even if i'm not there and see a picture of the place.”

“I'd love to learn the techniques that Monet was using in his paintings.”

P3 - User Needs

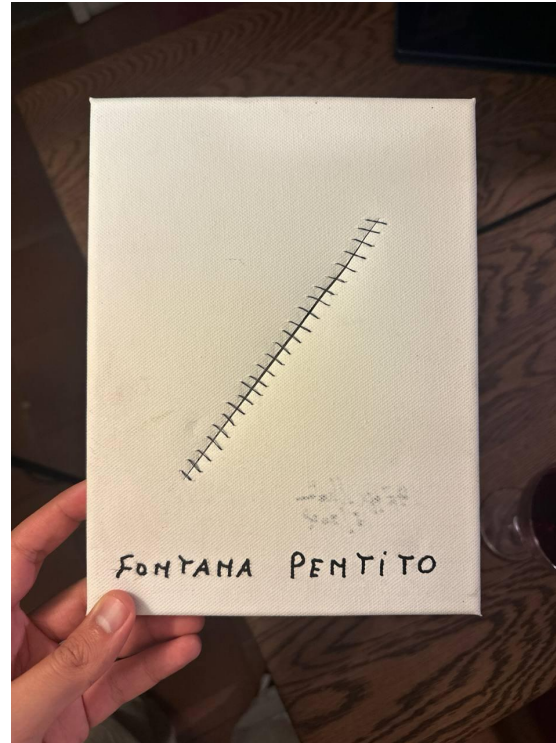
Needs to learn new techniques (like oil painting) in a simpler, more guided way.

Needs to practice in calm, focused environments without distractions.

Needs a way to see his own improvement over time visually.

Needs to use technology as a helper, but not a replacement for real art.

Results



P4

P4 - METHODOLOGY

Why chosen / appropriateness:

She is an artist with some art pieces exhibited in some art galleries in Istanbul and also she is giving workshops on drawing to people from different ages. Thus it makes her a viable candidate for a domain expert to interview for our topic.

Recruitment:

Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile:

26 years old, female, artist and art instructor.

Interview location:

Conducted via online video meeting

P4 - METHODOLOGY

Observation and questions:

Questions focused on her journey to become an artist and the motivations and teaching methods, student motivations and the challenges beginners are facing.

Team roles:

Yusa led the interview and asked questions, Ozgun took notes.

Materials used:

Laptop for conducting the online meeting and for notes.

P4 - Artifacts



P4 - Artifacts



P4 - Key Quotes

“I was very a emotional child and in daily life being emotional sometimes overwhelming. but when I was drawing, this emotion turned into something positive.”

“Many people just want to reconnect with themselves.”(answer is about motivations of people to go to workshops)

“The biggest fear of beginners is usually the fear of failure, not being good enough.”

“They respond best the honest but encouraging feedback when it's both positive and specific it reaches to them.”

“I also noticed that public appreciation like hanging their works on the wall for a mini exhibition builds confidence.”

“Patience and empathy are essential. It's not about showing how talented you are but about helping the others discover their own potential.”

P4 - User Needs

Needs a way to keep students motivated between classes.

Needs personalized ways to overcome the fear of failure.

Deep User Needs

Emotional connection matters more than skill

Drawing is often a personal and emotional activity rather than a purely technical one. Learners value self-expression, relaxation, and enjoyment over mastery.

(Seen in P1 and P3: drawing for calm and focus; P2 and P4: encourages emotional confidence in students.)

Beginners fear judgment and lack feedback

Many hesitate to draw because they fear failure or criticism. They want guidance and reassurance, not evaluation.

(Seen in P1: avoids public feedback; P2 and P4: needs tools for gentle, quick feedback; P3: His superior classmates intimidated him.)

Tools and materials can be barriers

Uncertainty about how to use tools and limited access to materials often discourage practice. Learners need easier ways to experiment safely.

(Seen in P1: afraid to waste materials; P3: The nature of some elements makes them harder to practice ; P2: bridges traditional and digital media.)

Community and feedback improve learning

Learning with others boosts motivation and helps overcome self-doubt. Regular, kind feedback keeps learners engaged between sessions.

(Seen in all participants: desire for shared spaces or teacher-student connection; P2 stresses motivation between classes.)

Digital tools help, but can't replace the human touch

Technology can support creativity by offering inspiration or structure, but it should never replace the personal or emotional side of art.

(Seen in P1: uses Pinterest for ideas; P2 and P3: value balance between digital aids and traditional practice.)

Solutions

Idea Brainstorm

Need 1: Find inspiration when stuck

Ideas:

- A shared board where users upload unfinished sketches for feedback.
- A “daily prompt” calendar for drawing challenges.
- An AI mood board that suggests nature images based on emotion.
- Offline “inspiration walks” guided by an app.
- A community card deck with random topics.

Need 2: Receive feedback and guidance

- Peer-to-peer review sessions among amateur artists.
- An “art mentor” matching platform.
- Anonymous feedback channel from instructors.
- Smart camera overlay that tracks proportions live.
- Hybrid offline/online workshop hub.

Need 3: Stay motivated and confident

Ideas:

- Progress timeline of past drawings.
- Gamified streak tracker with small weekly goals.
- Virtual group drawing nights.
- Reflection journal that records emotions while drawing.
- Reward badges for trying new techniques.

Need 4: Bridge digital & traditional art practice

Ideas:

- Augmented-reality overlay showing proportion guides on paper.
- Projector or tablet tool that tests colors before painting.
- Digital palette planner for oil and acrylic paints.
- Portable scanner to compare sketches with references.
- Smart stylus mimicking brush pressure for practice.

Project Proposition

Brainstorm Summary

During brainstorming, we explored several ideas around feedback, motivation, and creativity support:

A visual feedback tool that helps beginners identify mistakes gently.

A shared sketchboard where learners can exchange feedback anonymously.

A daily inspiration generator offering small, achievable prompts.

A teacher dashboard for instructors to send visual notes between classes.

An AI assistant that gives gentle feedbacks and can analyze the progress.

AR
drawing

reflection
journal

GENTLE
visual
feedback



daily
inspiration
prompts

draw
streaks



generative
AI

teacher
feedback
dashboard

progress
tracker
timeline

motivation
!!

Chosen Solution: “DrawTogether”

A supportive digital sketchbook for feedback and motivation

DrawTogether helps beginner artists stay motivated and improve through small, confidence-building steps.

The platform combines inspiration prompts, progress tracking, and a gentle visual feedback system that highlights proportions or shading areas without scoring or judging.

With the help of the AI assistant, the progress of the user can be analyzed whenever the user needs and asks for it.

Connected User Needs

Addresses “Beginners fear judgment and lack feedback.”

Supports “Community and feedback improve learning.”

Encourages emotional connection through supportive design rather than evaluation.

Mixes digital and physical tools to make learning accessible and by reducing the judgement factor, less scary and easy to start.

How and Why We Selected It

We chose this solution because every participant mentioned feedback as a key challenge — either lacking it (P1, P3) or struggling to give it effectively (P2).

It directly responds to the emotional and motivational barriers shared across all interviews.

Among the brainstormed options, this idea best balances creativity, emotional safety, and the use of digital tools without replacing human interaction.

The name also represents the guidance and fellowship that gives the sensation of support, which may be a big factor. The word “together” can mean a community, but also the ai assistant that’ll guide the user along the way.

